

4 The photograph shows a regent honeyeater.



(Source: © Dave Watts / Alamy Stock Photo)

- (a) Regent honeyeaters are critically endangered, with fewer than 300 birds left in the wild.

A study found that a large proportion of the male birds no longer sing the characteristic songs of their own species.

Some of the birds had learnt the songs of other species.

- (i) Suggest why a large proportion of these male birds no longer sing the characteristic songs of regent honeyeaters.

(1)

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- (ii) Explain the effect that this could have on the future of this species.

(3)

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(iii) Suggest how zoos could increase the number of birds in the wild that can sing the songs characteristic of this species.

(2)

(b) Genetic studies indicate that the regent honeyeater is related to wattlebirds.

Describe how genetic studies could show this.

(4)

(Total for Question 4 = 10 marks)